

THE FRONTIER GAZETTE

Special Report from the Northern Stations

Conclusions of the Commission

The commission concludes that the coastal survey achieved the greater part of its stated objectives. Positions were fixed for eleven of the fourteen proposed stations, and tidal series of at least six months were obtained at seven.

The loss of the third party's notebooks is regretted. The commission recommends that duplicate records be transmitted by post at fortnightly intervals in all future work of this character, and that no single vessel carry the whole of a season's observations.

The commission further records its appreciation of the resident observers, whose diligence under conditions of considerable hardship is evident throughout the returns.

Notes upon the Instruments

The barometric readings were corrected for temperature by the standard tables. Each observer recorded the dry-bulb and the wet-bulb temperature at the moment of reading, and the corrections were applied during the reduction of the data.

Errors of the aneroid barometer were found to be systematic rather than random. A correction curve was constructed for each instrument by comparison with the mercurial standard kept at the observatory, and the curves are reproduced in the appendix to this report.

Two chronometers were carried by each party. The rates were determined before departure and verified upon return, and the mean of the two was adopted for all longitude determinations.